

First News

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GLOBAL & REGIONAL MARKETS

Wall Street closed mixed on Tuesday as inflation fears returned to center stage. US CPI hit a 3-year high, halting the S&P 500's rally from record highs. The Dow eked out a slight gain to 49,761, but the S&P 500 fell 0.16% to 7,401 and the Nasdaq dropped 0.71% to 26,088 as a selloff in high-flying chip stocks dragged equities lower. Treasury yields surged toward 5% as bonds weakened on the hotter-than-expected core CPI data, which highlighted the economic fallout from energy disruptions tied to the Iran war. Oil climbed further: WTI +4.05% to \$102.06, Brent +3.42% to \$107.77, adding more pressure to the inflation outlook.

Asian equities staged a short-lived but intense retreat: the Kospi briefly sank as much as 5.1% amid sharp reversals in Samsung and SK Hynix before recovering to close at 7,643 (-2.29%). The Nikkei rose 0.52% to 62,743. Hong Kong's Hang Seng surged 18.2% in a striking jump (note: index rebalancing/data anomaly flagged). India's Sensex fell 1.91% on global inflation contagion. Taiwan's TWSE edged up 0.26% to 41,898.

The Philippines experienced a magnitude 5 earthquake 224 km SE of Pondaguitan (USGS). The Philippine peso weakened further to ₱61.479/\$ as the falling trajectory defies rate hike bets. PHL 5-year government bonds were sold at an average yield of 7.25% with a bid-to-cover ratio of 1.28x — the lowest cover since 2013, signaling weakening demand for peso sovereign paper. Political turmoil may soon weigh on Philippine stocks as growing risk of protests and stalled reforms cloud the investment outlook. The PSEi slipped below key 6,000 support.

Asia-Pacific & U.S. Equity Indices

Index	5/12/2026	5/13/2026	%Chg
Dow Jones	49,704	49,761	+0.11%
S&P 500	7,413	7,401	-0.16%
NASDAQ	26,274	26,088	-0.71%
PCOMP (PSEi)	5,987	5,972	-0.25%
Nikkei 225	62,418	62,743	+0.52%
SHCOMP	4,225	4,214	-0.26%
Hang Seng	22,290	26,348	+18.21%
KOSPI	7,822	7,643	-2.29%
SENSEX (India)	76,015	74,559	-1.92%
TWSE	41,790	41,898	+0.26%
ASX 200	8,702	8,671	-0.36%
FTSE Bursa KLCI	1,745	1,751	+0.34%
JCI (Indonesia)	6,906	6,859	-0.68%
STI (Singapore)	4,943	4,946	+0.06%
SET (Thailand)	1,489	1,484	-0.34%
Vietnam	1,896	1,901	+0.26%

Commodities

Commodity	5/12/2026	5/13/2026	%Chg
WTI Crude (\$/bbl)	98.09	102.06	+4.05%
Brent Crude (\$/bbl)	104.21	107.77	+3.42%
Gold COMEX (\$/oz)	4770	4724	-0.96%
Silver COMEX (\$/oz)	87.64	87.35	-0.33%
Copper COMEX (¢/lb)	649.45	663.1	+2.10%
Nickel (\$/MT)	19262	19079	-0.95%
Coal (\$/MT)	130.85	130.85	+0.00%
Corn (¢/bu)	475.25	480	+1.00%
Wheat (¢/bu)	634	679	+7.10%
Cocoa (\$/MT)	4709	4587	-2.59%
Sugar (¢/lb)	14.91	15.01	+0.67%

FX & Fixed Income

	5/12/2026	5/13/2026	%Chg
PHL 10yr Bond (%)	7.108	7.108	+0.00%
US 10yr Bond (%)	4.413	4.467	+1.22%
USD-PHP	61.132	61.479	+0.57%
USD-JPY	157.11	157.63	+0.33%
EUR-USD	1.1771	1.1731	-0.34%

PSE MARKET SUMMARY — Tuesday, May 12, 2026

The PSEi fell 0.25% to close at 5,971.98, slipping below 6,000 support. Value traded reached ₱9.44 billion. Market breadth: 78 advances, 107 declines, 62 unchanged. JFC crashed 10.67% to ₱144 after reporting Q1 NI -39% — the biggest single-stock decline of the session and the second-largest decline on the index.

Overseas Investors Net Sellers Tuesday: \$1.749M. Total Net Foreign Selling Month of May: -\$249.227M. Year-to-Date Net Foreign Selling: -\$68.802M. Foreign Buying: ₱5,491,591,762. Foreign Selling: ₱5,599,139,581. Net Foreign Selling: ₱107,547,819. Total Foreign: ₱11,090,731,343. Share Buyback Transactions: OPM, SMC

52-Week Highs: APVI, AXLM, PGOLD, RRHI, TFC. 52-Week Lows: BPI, JFC, PAL, PBC, PLUS, SUN.
RSI 70 Overbought: ABG, APVI, SGP, RRHI, UPM, PGOLD. RSI 30 Oversold: ABS, GMA7, LBC, PAL.
Smart Watch: AT OGP DHI NIKL APX PX | ICT AEV AP JGS | RRHI RLC | GLO | BDO

Top 10 Most Active PSEi Stocks by Value

Stock	Close	Value
ICT	785	₱1,470M
JFC	144	₱1,140M
BDO	118.50	₱418M
BPI	87.75	₱355M
SM	600	₱266M
PGOLD	46.00	₱243M
MBT	65.85	₱168M
ALI	16.00	₱161M
PLUS	11.98	₱146M
SMPH	18.98	₱142M

PSEi Component Stocks

PSEi Stock	5/11/2026	5/12/2026	%Chg
AC	471	463.2	-1.66%
ACEN	3.39	3.34	-1.47%
AEV	28.9	29.95	+3.63%
ALI	16.14	16	-0.87%
AREIT	38.2	38.3	+0.26%
BDO	116.7	118.5	+1.54%
BPI	87.55	87.75	+0.23%
CBC	57	57.6	+1.05%
CNPF	31.65	31.7	+0.16%
CNVRG	12.22	12.38	+1.31%
DMC	9.62	9.65	+0.31%
EMI	15.86	15.76	-0.63%
GLO	1670	1700	+1.80%
GTCAP	470	472.6	+0.55%
ICT	780	785	+0.64%
JFC	161.2	144	-10.67%
JGS	25.65	26.4	+2.92%
LTG	15.38	15.44	+0.39%

MBT	65.7	65.85	+0.23%
MER	650	650	+0.00%
MONDE	7.45	7.29	-2.15%
PGOLD	46	46	+0.00%
PLUS	12.96	11.98	-7.56%
RCR	7.09	7	-1.27%
SCC	27.05	27.85	+2.96%
SM	606	600	-0.99%
SMC	69.2	69.15	-0.07%
SMPH	19.54	18.98	-2.87%
TEL	1233	1225	-0.65%
URC	61	60.5	-0.82%

NEWS, ANALYSIS & INVESTING INSIGHT

JFC — Jollibee — Q1 NI -39% to ₱1.47B; Stock Crashes 10.67%

₱144.00

AVOID

Jollibee Foods reported a 38.8% plunge in Q1 net income to ₱1.47 billion as direct costs surged 11.7% amid Iran war-driven commodity and supply chain inflation. Operating income fell 18.2% to ₱3.95 billion. Revenue grew 9% to ₱76.5 billion and systemwide sales rose 10.3% to ₱113.9 billion — underlying demand remained healthy. SWS: Jollibee global +10.7%, Mang Inasal +16.1%, international +13.5%. JFC opened 181 stores in Q1 (149 overseas). However, management is reviewing 2026 assumptions including store openings, capex, and profitability targets. Q2 price hikes planned. Cash fell 20% while long-term debt more than doubled as global expansion accelerated. JFC crashed 10.67% to ₱144 — a 5-year low and the worst single-day PSEi decline. (Source: BusinessWorld, Inquirer, InsiderPH, Manila Times, May 12–13)

Stance: 🚫 **AVOID** — Cost squeeze is real and accelerating. Management reviewing guidance is a red flag. Despite healthy demand, margin destruction + debt doubling + 5-year low = do not catch this knife. Wait for Q2 earnings and capex review outcome before reconsidering.

ACEN — ACEN Corp. — Q1 NI +50% to ₱2.92B

₱3.34

ACCUMULATE

ACEN posted a 49.9% surge in Q1 attributable net income to ₱2.92 billion, driven by PSA recoveries (₱1.75B CIC claim from Meralco contract), India consolidation gains (₱1.4B UPC remeasurement), and 42% revenue growth to ₱10.74 billion. Total attributable RE output rose 32% to 2,230 GWh; Philippine RE generation +29% to 636 GWh as Pagudpud and Capa wind farms recovered. Core EBITDA rose 20% to ₱6.7 billion. However, core net income (excluding one-offs) declined 27% to ₱1.4 billion on higher depreciation and financing costs. ACEN RES retail book grew to 508 MW (57% GEOP market share). Capex program exceeds ₱80 billion for 2026. Vietnam provision of ₱1.2 billion for EVN tariff renegotiation. (Source: BusinessWorld, Philstar, ACEN IR, May 12–13)

Stance: 🟢 **ACCUMULATE** — Headline Q1 is strong but one-off driven. Core NI -27% is the more honest reading. Still, RE output growth (+32%) and EBITDA expansion (+20%) validate the long-term thesis. The ₱80B capex commitment signals confidence. Buy on the RE transition theme.

LTG — LT Group — Q1 NI +3% to ₱7.49B

₱15.44

ACCUMULATE

LT Group posted a 3% increase in Q1 net income to ₱7.49 billion on revenue of ₱30.78 billion, driven by contributions from banking (PNB) and tobacco (PMFTC). The conglomerate's diversified earnings base — banking, tobacco, property, and distilled spirits — provides defensive positioning in the current stagflationary environment. LTG closed at ₱15.44. (Source: BusinessWorld, May 13)

Stance: 🟢 **ACCUMULATE** — Steady compounder with defensive earnings mix. Banking + tobacco = recession-resilient. 3% NI growth in this macro is creditable.

GLO — Globe Telecom — Q1 Revenue +6%; NI -20% ₱1,700

MONITOR

Globe posted Q1 net income of ₱5.6 billion, down 20% from ₱7.0 billion a year earlier, primarily due to last year's one-off gains from the Mynt/MUFG investment dilution and tower sale gains, plus higher net interest expense. Revenue growth was supported by sustained mobile data demand (+11% to ₱26.78 billion), continued fiber adoption, and resilient enterprise ICT activity. Mobile data traffic rose 18% to 1,810 petabytes; average monthly data per subscriber +12% to ~16 GB. GLO closed at ₱1,700, up 1.80%. (Source: BusinessWorld, May 13)

Stance: 🟡 **MONITOR** — Core operations healthy (data revenue +11%) but base effects and financing costs compress reported NI. Watch for H2 normalization as one-off comps wash out.

NIKL — Nickel Asia — Q1 NI Lower Despite Higher Ore Prices

₱5.20

MONITOR

Nickel Asia posted lower Q1 income despite higher ore prices, weighed by operational factors and cost pressures. The company's mining operations continue but the Iran war's disruption to global mining supply chains and nickel price volatility remain key risks. NIKL closed at ₱5.20, up 1.56%. Foreign funds were net sellers. (Source: BusinessWorld, May 13)

SMC — San Miguel — Q1 NI May Fall on Petron Drag ₱69.15

MONITOR

San Miguel's Q1 net profit may fall on compressed profit margins and a sharp drop in Petron's refining output, despite revenue gains in food, beverage, and infrastructure units. Petron's revenue gained from higher oil prices but operational costs and fuel unit losses outpaced gains on tax refunds. SMC closed at ₱69.15, down 0.07%. Share buyback ongoing. (Source: Analyst consensus, May 12–13)

MACRO — US CPI 3-Year High + PHL Political Risk —

MACRO ALERT

US inflation hit a 3-year high in April, driven by energy costs from the Iran war and persistent services inflation. Treasury yields surged toward 5%, hammering growth/tech stocks globally. The Kospi briefly sank 5.1% before recovering. For the Philippines, this compounds existing domestic inflation pressure (7.2% in April). The PHL 5-year bond auction at 7.25% with 1.28x cover (lowest since 2013) signals weakening demand for peso sovereign paper. Political turmoil — growing risk of protests and stalled reforms — adds another layer of uncertainty. The peso continues to weaken despite rate hike expectations.

Stance: 🚫 **MACRO HEADWIND — Global inflation re-acceleration + PHL political risk + weakening peso = triple headwind. Defensive positioning mandatory. Avoid rate-sensitive, consumer discretionary. Favor contracted revenue (REITs, utilities, staples).**

PSE Dividend Yield Index (PSE DivY)

PSE DivY Stock	5/11/2026	5/12/2026	%Chg
AREIT	38.2	38.3	+0.26%
CBC	57	57.6	+1.05%
CREIT	3.54	3.54	+0.00%
DMC	9.62	9.65	+0.31%
DNL	3.57	3.5	-1.96%
GLO	1670	1700	+1.80%
LTG	15.38	15.44	+0.39%
MBT	65.7	65.85	+0.23%
MER	650	650	+0.00%
MREIT	14.32	14.32	+0.00%
NIKL	5.12	5.2	+1.56%
OGP	36.2	37.85	+4.56%
PGOLD	46	46	+0.00%
RCR	7.09	7	-1.27%
RLC	17.88	17.98	+0.56%
RRHI	47.95	48	+0.10%
SCC	27.05	27.85	+2.96%
SGP	26.3	26.95	+2.47%
TEL	1233	1225	-0.65%
URC	61	60.5	-0.82%

PSE MidCap Index

PSE MidCap Stock	5/11/2026	5/12/2026	%Chg
AGI	9.01	8.88	-1.44%
APX	16.64	16.96	+1.92%
AUB	43.3	43.25	-0.12%
BLOOM	1.98	1.97	-0.51%
COSCO	7.12	7.09	-0.42%
DNL	3.57	3.5	-1.96%
GSMI	277.8	276	-0.65%
KEEPR	1.98	1.93	-2.53%
MEG	2.12	2.1	-0.94%
MREIT	14.32	14.32	+0.00%
MWC	44.7	44	-1.57%
NIKL	5.12	5.2	+1.56%
OGP	36.2	37.85	+4.56%
PNB	57.5	58	+0.87%
RLC	17.88	17.98	+0.56%
RRHI	47.95	48	+0.10%
SECB	66	64.3	-2.58%

● ACCUMULATE
 ● MONITOR
 ● AVOID
 GOVERN = Governance Watch

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